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Email: st_anns_coll@yahoo.co.in

ST. ANN'S COLLEGE FOR WOMEN

Run by The Society of St Anne

Affiliated to Acharya Nagarjuna University, Approved by AICTE

Recognised under Section 2(f) of the UGC Act 1956, New Delhi.

Accredited by NAAC with 'A' Grade in the first cycle

Amaravathi Road, Gorantla, Guntur-34, Andhra Pradesh, India.



Website: www.stannscollegeforwomen.org

Grievance Redressal Committee

Guidelines & Procedures

1. Introduction

The Grievance Redressal Committee (GRC) of St. Ann's College for Women, Gorantla, Guntur is constituted to provide a fair, transparent, and effective mechanism for redressal of grievances of students and staff members. The committee functions in accordance with the guidelines of UGC, NAAC, and the policies of the institution to ensure a harmonious and supportive academic environment.

The committee promotes equality, justice, mutual respect, and accountability while maintaining confidentiality and impartiality in handling grievances.

2. Objectives

The objectives of the Grievance Redressal Committee are to:

- Provide a safe and accessible platform for students and staff to express grievances.
- Ensure fair, transparent, and timely redressal of complaints.
- Prevent harassment, discrimination, victimization, and unfair practices.
- Promote harmonious relationships among students, faculty, and staff.
- Ensure confidentiality and protection of complainants.
- Encourage amicable settlement of issues wherever possible.
- Uphold institutional discipline and ethical standards.
- Create awareness regarding grievance redressal mechanisms and procedures.

3. Scope of Grievances

The committee shall address grievances related to:

- Academic issues
- Attendance-related concerns
- Examination-related complaints

- Harassment or discrimination
- Student-teacher disputes
- Staff grievances
- Infrastructure and basic facilities
- Administrative issues
- Behavioral misconduct
- Unfair practices within the institution

The committee shall not entertain matters that fall under:

- Sexual Harassment (handled by Internal Complaints Committee)
- Ragging (handled by Anti-Ragging Committee)
- Matters pending before courts or legal authorities

4. Constitution of the Committee

The Grievance Redressal Committee shall consist of:

- Principal – Chairperson
- Senior Faculty Members
- Women Representative
- Administrative Representative
- Student Representatives (where applicable)
- IQAC Representative
- Counselor / Mentor (if required)

The Principal may modify the composition of the committee as per institutional requirements.

5. Roles and Responsibilities

The committee shall:

- Create awareness about grievance redressal procedures.
- Receive and register complaints confidentially.
- Examine grievances fairly and impartially.

- Conduct enquiry meetings when necessary.
- Provide opportunities for both parties to present their views.
- Counsel students and staff for amicable resolution.
- Recommend corrective and disciplinary actions when required.
- Ensure timely resolution of grievances.
- Maintain proper documentation and records.
- Submit reports to the Principal periodically.

6. Grievance Redressal Procedure

Step 1: Submission of Grievance

- The aggrieved student or staff member may submit the grievance in writing or through the prescribed grievance form.
- Complaints may be submitted physically or through institutional email/online grievance portal.
- Anonymous complaints may be considered only if supported by valid evidence.

Step 2: Registration of Complaint

- The grievance shall be recorded in the Grievance Register.
- An acknowledgement shall be provided to the complainant.

Step 3: Preliminary Review

- The committee shall review the nature of the complaint.
- If the grievance falls under another statutory committee, it shall be forwarded accordingly.

Step 4: Investigation and Enquiry

- The committee may:
 - Interact with concerned parties
 - Collect relevant documents and evidence
 - Conduct meetings or hearings
 - Seek clarification from departments concerned

Step 5: Resolution and Action

- Appropriate corrective measures shall be recommended.
- Efforts shall be made to resolve grievances amicably and fairly.
- Disciplinary action may be recommended in serious cases.

Step 6: Communication of Decision

- The decision of the committee shall be communicated confidentially to the concerned parties.

Step 7: Follow-Up

- The committee shall monitor implementation of the recommendations and maintain records for future reference.

7. General Guidelines

- All grievances shall be handled with confidentiality and sensitivity.
- No complainant shall face discrimination or retaliation.
- False or malicious complaints may attract disciplinary action.
- The committee shall ensure natural justice and impartial enquiry.
- Grievances should preferably be resolved within a reasonable timeframe.
- Proper records and reports shall be maintained for NAAC and institutional purposes.

8. Meetings

- The committee shall meet periodically or whenever required.
- Emergency meetings may be conducted for urgent matters.
- Minutes of meetings shall be recorded and maintained.

9. Documentation and Records

The committee shall maintain:

- Grievance Register
- Complaint Forms
- Enquiry Reports

- Action Taken Reports
- Minutes of Meetings
- Annual Reports and Supporting Documents

10. Outcome and Support Measures

Depending on the nature of grievance, the committee may recommend:

- Counseling and guidance
- Warning or disciplinary measures
- Corrective administrative action
- Academic support measures
- Mediation and reconciliation
- Referral to higher authorities if necessary

11. NAAC & UGC Compliance

The Grievance Redressal Committee functions in alignment with:

- UGC Grievance Redressal Regulations
- NAAC Quality Mandates
- Institutional Code of Conduct
- Student Support and Governance Framework

The committee contributes to:

- Student Welfare
- Institutional Transparency
- Participative Governance
- Quality Assurance and Accountability

12. Conclusion

St. Ann's College for Women, Gorantla, Guntur is committed to maintaining a fair, inclusive, respectful, and student-friendly environment. The Grievance Redressal Committee plays a vital role in ensuring justice, transparency, and institutional harmony by addressing grievances effectively and responsibly.

